Winter option 1

What we are eating

- **Lunch, Mon to Wed:** Vegetarian Japanese curry
- **Lunch, Thu and Fri (and Wednesday's dinner):** Teriyaki tofu bowls
- **Dinner, Mon and Tue:** Vegetarian bibimbap
- **Dinner, Thu and Fri:** Kopytka (potato dumplings)
- **Breakfast:** Blueberry banana baked oatmeal **Snack:** Energy balls
- **For him only:** Plain baked chicken breast, diced: 10 portions of 100 g (about 1.3 kg raw), added to his lunches, Wednesday's dinner and the kopytka.
- **Weekend:** Lentil soup for lunch and Zapiekanka for dinner, both days; eggs on toast for breakfast.

The week at a glance

DAYS	BREAKFAST	LUNCH (PACKED)	SNACK	DINNER	DAY TOTAL
Mon, Tue	**Blueberry banana baked oatmeal** **HIM** 1.4 squares + Greek yogurt 175 g + 1/2 x almonds 30 g 513 kcal, 28 g **HER** 1 square + Greek yogurt 175 g + apple 436 kcal, 23 g	**Vegetarian Japanese curry** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 679 kcal, 41 g **HER** 3 parts + edamame 100 g 506 kcal, 18 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Vegetarian bibimbap** **HIM** 4 parts 592 kcal, 29 g **HER** 3 parts 444 kcal, 21 g	**HIM 2176 kcal**, 122 g **HER 1712 kcal**, 86 g
Wed	**Blueberry banana baked oatmeal** **HIM** 1.4 squares + Greek yogurt 175 g + 1/2 x almonds 30 g 513 kcal, 28 g **HER** 1 square + Greek yogurt 175 g + apple 436 kcal, 23 g	**Vegetarian Japanese curry** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 679 kcal, 41 g **HER** 3 parts + edamame 100 g 506 kcal, 18 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Teriyaki tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + 1/2 cup brown rice + 100 g diced chicken 610 kcal, 50 g **HER** 3 parts + 3/4 cup brown rice + edamame 100 g 534 kcal, 27 g	**HIM 2194 kcal**, 143 g **HER 1803 kcal**, 91 g
Thu, Fri	**Blueberry banana baked oatmeal** **HIM** 1.4 squares + Greek yogurt 175 g + 1/2 x almonds 30 g 513 kcal, 28 g **HER** 1 square + Greek yogurt 175 g + apple 436 kcal, 23 g	**Teriyaki tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + 1/2 cup brown rice + 100 g diced chicken 610 kcal, 50 g **HER** 3 parts + 3/4 cup brown rice + edamame 100 g 534 kcal, 27 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Kopytka (potato dumplings)** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 629 kcal, 44 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 448 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2144 kcal**, 146 g **HER 1745 kcal**, 96 g
Sat	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Lentil soup** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 640 kcal, 56 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cheddar 30 g 507 kcal, 26 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Zapiekanka** **HIM** 4 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 621 kcal, 38 g **HER** 3 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 498 kcal, 33 g	**HIM 2214 kcal**, 156 g **HER 1737 kcal**, 99 g
Sun	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Lentil soup** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 640 kcal, 56 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cheddar 30 g 507 kcal, 26 g	**Energy balls** **HIM** 2 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 392 kcal, 25 g **HER** 1.5 balls + Greek yogurt 175 g 326 kcal, 23 g	**Zapiekanka** **HIM** 4 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 621 kcal, 38 g **HER** 3 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 498 kcal, 33 g	**HIM 2214 kcal**, 156 g **HER 1737 kcal**, 99 g

"4 parts" and "3 parts" are the his and hers shares of a cooked dish. Numbers are kcal and grams of protein.

The rhythm

Sunday, about 2 hours

1. Start with vegetarian Japanese curry (about 130 min). Make 1 1/4 x the recipe (5 servings).
2. Then blueberry banana baked oatmeal (about 45 min). Make 2 x the recipe (12 squares).
3. Then energy balls (10 min of work plus 30 min chilling). Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (27 balls).
4. Bake his chicken: about 1.3 kg raw breast with salt, pepper, garlic powder and a little oil, 20 to 25 min at 425 F. Dice it and bag 10 portions of 100 g. Keep 3 in the fridge and freeze the rest, moving them down a day ahead.
5. Cook brown rice for the lunch boxes: 2 1/2 cups cooked (160 g dry).
6. Box the lunches for Monday to Wednesday. Teriyaki tofu bowls is cooked fresh on Wednesday evening.

The rest of the week

Monday	Cook vegetarian bibimbap (about 50 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Tuesday	No cooking. Leftovers from Monday.
Wednesday	Cook teriyaki tofu bowls (about 30 min). Eat it for dinner and box Thursday's and Friday's lunches.
Thursday	Cook Kopytka (potato dumplings) (about 40 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Friday	No cooking.
Saturday	Midday: make lentil soup (about 55 min) for today's and tomorrow's lunch. Evening: cook Zapiekanka (about 30 min) for tonight's and tomorrow's dinner. Breakfast both days is eggs on toast.
Sunday	Leftovers from Saturday for lunch and dinner. Afternoon: prep the next option.

Groceries used: $190.87 for both of you for the seven days ($95.44 each). Buying every pack new costs about $323.84 at the till; most of the difference stays in the pantry for later options.

Shopping list: Winter option 1

For both of you, Monday to Sunday. Save-On-Foods prices seen Nov 10, 2026. Check the fridge and pantry first: oats, rice, soy sauce, honey, peanut butter and oil last for several options.

From H Mart, not priced

Cooking sake (or any dry sake); Gochujang (Korean chili paste). Tofu, ginger, green onions and mushrooms are usually cheaper there too.

Pantry check (not on the list below)

Salt, pepper, neutral cooking oil, sugar or brown sugar, flour, cornstarch, vinegar, plus: Japanese curry powder, garam masala, cayenne, bay leaf, cornstarch or potato starch, sesame seeds, cinnamon, baking powder, vanilla, dried thyme (and about 325 g of the flour), cumin, coriander, paprika, bay leaves, ketchup, garlic powder.

ITEM	NEED	BUY	PACK PRICE	COST OF AMOUNT USED
Produce				
☐ Ambrosia apple	8.25	9 x each, about 207 g	$0.91	$7.51
☐ Banana	4	4 x each	$0.39	$1.56
☐ Bean sprouts	120 g	1 x 227 g	$2.99	$1.58
☐ Butternut squash	175 g	loose, by weight	$0.37/100 g	$0.65
☐ Carrots	436 g	1 x 5 lb bag	$7.99	$1.54
☐ Celery	150 g	1 x bunch, about 675 g	$5.49	$1.22
☐ Fresh ginger	6 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$0.04
☐ Garlic	0.6 bulb	1 x 3 bulbs	$1.29	$0.26
☐ Green kale	1 bunch	1 x bunch	$4.49	$4.49
☐ Green onions	0.9 bunch	1 x bunch	$2.49	$2.24
☐ Lemon	1	1 x each	$0.99	$0.99
☐ Long eggplant	144 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$0.95
☐ Red bell pepper	1.25	2 x each	$2.98	$3.73
☐ Tomatoes on the vine	188 g	loose, by weight	$0.84/100 g	$1.57
☐ White mushrooms, loose	790 g	loose, by weight	$1.32/100 g	$10.43
☐ Yellow onions	580 g	1 x 3 lb bag	$4.99	$2.13
☐ Yellow potatoes	1.32 kg	1 x 10 lb bag	$6.99	$2.04
Meat & deli				
☐ Chicken breast, boneless skinless, warehouse pack	1.3 kg	2 x about 1.25 kg	$20.64	$21.47
Dairy & eggs				
☐ 2% milk (Dairyland)	500 mL	1 x 4 L	$6.35	$0.79
☐ Cottage cheese 2% (Dairyland)	250 g	1 x 750 g	$8.25	$2.75
☐ Extra firm tofu (Sunrise)	3.41 block	4 x 350 g	$3.99	$13.61
☐ Greek yogurt, plain 2% (Olympic)	5.25 kg	3 x 1.75 kg	$12.29	$36.87
☐ Large white eggs	16	1 x 18	$7.45	$6.62
☐ Medium cheddar block (Western Family)	210 g	1 x 600 g	$8.49	$2.97
☐ Salted butter (Western Family)	132 g	1 x 454 g	$6.69	$1.95
Grains & bakery				
☐ Classic baguette (Bake Shop)	1	1 x 350 g	$3.49	$3.49
☐ Green lentils, bulk bin	400 g	loose, by weight	$0.89/100 g	$3.56
☐ Large flake oats (Rogers)	345 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.00	$1.73
☐ Long grain brown rice (Western Family)	569 g	1 x 907 g	$3.99	$2.50
☐ Panko bread crumbs (Western Family)	25 g	1 x 227 g	$3.59	$0.40
☐ Quinoa, bulk bin	115 g	loose, by weight	$1.49/100 g	$1.71
☐ Sourdough bread, sliced (Bake Shop)	10 slice	1 x 567 g, about 12 slices	$3.99	$3.33
Pantry & cans				
☐ Diced tomatoes in juice (Western Family)	400 mL	1 x 796 mL can	$2.39	$1.20
☐ Extra virgin olive oil (Western Family)	101 mL	1 x 1 L	$15.99	$1.62
☐ Ground flaxseed (Only Goodness)	21 g	1 x 453 g	$8.99	$0.42
☐ Liquid honey (Western Family)	382 g	1 x 1 kg	$14.79	$5.64
☐ Mini semi-sweet chocolate chips (Chipits)	128 g	1 x 270 g	$6.79	$3.21
☐ Mirin (Kikkoman Kotteri)	120 mL	1 x 296 mL	$6.99	$2.83
☐ Natural smooth peanut butter (Western Family)	195 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.99	$1.17
☐ Natural whole almonds, bulk bin	75 g	loose, by weight	$1.99/100 g	$1.49
☐ Pure sesame oil (Kosa)	45 mL	1 x 185 mL	$3.99	$0.97
☐ Soy sauce, less sodium (Western Family)	165 mL	1 x 450 mL	$3.49	$1.28
☐ Vegetable broth, low sodium (Western Family)	2.4 L	3 x 946 mL	$2.49	$6.32
☐ Walnut halves and pieces, bulk bin	60 g	loose, by weight	$2.69/100 g	$1.61
Frozen				
☐ Frozen asparagus spears (Western Family)	175 g	1 x 300 g	$2.99	$1.74
☐ Frozen blueberries (Western Family)	440 g	1 x 600 g	$6.99	$5.13
☐ Frozen edamame beans (Western Family)	600 g	2 x 500 g	$2.99	$3.59
Allowance for spices, oil, vinegar and the H Mart items below (my estimate, not priced)				**$6.00**
Groceries used for this option, both of you				**$190.87**
At the till if every pack is bought new (the remainder carries into later weeks)				**$323.84**

Cook and split: Winter option 1

In cooking order. The outline is a reminder in my words; follow the linked recipe for amounts of seasoning and exact steps.

Vegetarian Japanese curry SUNDAY

For Mon, Tue and Wed lunches · Make 1 1/4 x the recipe (5 servings) · about 130 min · full recipe: justonecookbook.com/vegetarian-japanese-curry (Just One Cookbook)

BUY FOR IT 70 g salted butter; 350 g yellow onions; 325 g yellow potatoes; 175 g butternut squash; 106 g carrots; 6 g fresh ginger; 1.25 red bell pepper; 175 g frozen asparagus spears; 144 g long eggplant; 375 g white mushrooms, loose; 188 g tomatoes on the vine; 56 mL extra virgin olive oil; 900 mL vegetable broth, low sodium; 1.25 ambrosia apple; 325 g long grain brown rice. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Cook butter and flour to a dark roux (12 to 15 min), then stir in curry powder, garam masala and cayenne. 2. Soften the onion; add potato, squash, carrot, ginger, tomato, bay and stock and simmer. 3. Saute the peppers, asparagus, eggplant and mushrooms separately so they keep their shape. 4. Stir in the roux and grated apple until thick, then fold in the sauteed vegetables.

SPLIT Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Mon, Tue and Wed lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.95 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.71.

SIDES Him: nothing extra. Her: edamame 100 g.

KEEP 3 days in the fridge, a month in the freezer; take the potatoes out before freezing (author).

REHEAT Microwave 2 to 3 min with the rice.

ALLERGENS Wheat (flour), milk (butter)

HEAT Leave out the optional cayenne. The curry is then mild and sweet.

NOTE From-scratch roux, no boxed cubes. Costed with butternut squash for kabocha, white mushrooms for the three Japanese kinds, and frozen asparagus. The tomato is cooked into the sauce. Low in protein by itself, which is why eggs or his kotlet go with it.

Blueberry banana baked oatmeal SUNDAY

For breakfasts, Mon to Fri · Make 2 x the recipe (12 squares) · about 45 min · full recipe: skinnytaste.com/baked-oatmeal-with-blueberries-and (Skinnytaste)

BUY FOR IT 4 banana; 440 g frozen blueberries; 170 g liquid honey; 180 g large flake oats; 60 g walnut halves and pieces, bulk bin; 500 mL 2% milk; 2 large white eggs. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Layer banana slices and half the blueberries in a baking dish with honey and cinnamon; bake 15 min. 2. Mix oats, nuts, baking powder; whisk milk, egg, honey and vanilla. 3. Top the fruit with the oat mix and the liquid, add the rest of the berries, bake about 30 min.

SPLIT Each weekday: 1.4 squares for him, 1 square for her. That uses all 12.

SIDES Him: Greek yogurt 175 g, 1/2 x almonds 30 g. Her: Greek yogurt 175 g, apple.

KEEP 3 to 4 days in the fridge (author). Freeze Friday's squares (my guidance).

REHEAT Microwave about 60 s (author).

ALLERGENS Eggs, milk, tree nuts (walnuts); oats can carry gluten

Energy balls SUNDAY

For snacks, Mon to Fri · Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (27 balls) · about 40 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/energy-balls (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT 165 g large flake oats; 21 g ground flaxseed; 195 g natural smooth peanut butter; 170 g liquid honey; 128 g mini semi-sweet chocolate chips. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.

OUTLINE 1. Stir oats, flax, peanut butter, honey, vanilla and chocolate chips. 2. Chill 30 min, then roll into about 18 balls.

SPLIT Every day including the weekend: 2 balls for him, 1.5 balls for her. 2.5 left over for the weekend or the freezer.

SIDES Him: Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: Greek yogurt 175 g.

KEEP 2 weeks in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author).

REHEAT Eat cold.

ALLERGENS Peanuts; chocolate chips usually contain milk and soy; oats can carry gluten

Vegetarian bibimbap MONDAY EVENING

For Mon and Tue dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 50 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/vegetarian-bibimbap (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	1.15 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 42 g liquid honey; 45 mL pure sesame oil; 1 bunch green kale; 120 g bean sprouts; 0.4 bulb garlic; 15 mL extra virgin olive oil; 0.5 bunch green onions; 115 g white mushrooms, loose; 180 g carrots; 4 large white eggs; 115 g quinoa, bulk bin. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Crisp the tofu. 2. Blanch the kale and bean sprouts separately and dress each with soy and sesame oil. 3. Saute the mushrooms, then the carrot matchsticks. 4. Fry the eggs. Build bowls over quinoa and top with the gochujang sauce.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Mon and Tue dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: nothing extra.
KEEP	Vegetables and tofu keep up to 2 days (author), which is why this is a Monday and Tuesday dinner.
REHEAT	Rewarm the vegetables and tofu in a pan; fry the eggs fresh.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame, eggs
H MART	Gochujang (Korean chili paste)
HEAT	The gochujang sauce goes on top, not in the dish: a small dab for her, a full spoon for him.
NOTE	Meatless. Costed with white mushrooms in place of shiitake.

Teriyaki tofu bowls WEDNESDAY EVENING

For Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches · Make 2 x the recipe (4 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: justonecookbook.com/teriyaki-tofu-bowl (Just One Cookbook)

BUY FOR IT	2.26 block extra firm tofu; 120 mL mirin; 120 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 0.4 bunch green onions. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Drain and press the tofu, slice it and dust with starch. 2. Whisk sake, mirin, soy and sugar for the teriyaki sauce. 3. Pan-fry the tofu until golden on both sides, pour in the sauce and reduce until glossy. 4. Serve over rice with scallions and sesame seeds.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.76 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.57.
SIDES	Him: 1/2 cup brown rice. Her: 3/4 cup brown rice, edamame 100 g.
KEEP	3 days in an airtight container; the author advises against freezing tofu.
REHEAT	Microwave 60 to 90 s with the rice.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame
H MART	Cooking sake (or any dry sake)
NOTE	The recipe serves 2, so this plan doubles it. Its nutrition figure does not appear to include the rice, so rice is counted as a side. Sake is not costed.

Kopytka (potato dumplings) THURSDAY EVENING

For Thu and Fri dinners · Make the recipe once (8 servings) · about 40 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-kopytka-dumplings (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	1 kg yellow potatoes; 2 large white eggs; 42 g salted butter; 25 g panko bread crumbs. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Boil the potatoes in their skins, peel, mash or rice them and cool. 2. Knead quickly with flour, eggs and salt. 3. Roll into thumb-thick ropes and cut into small diagonal pieces. 4. Boil in salted water until they float; top with butter-toasted breadcrumbs.
SPLIT	Set 3 servings aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Thu and Fri dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.4 of the recipe's servings, hers about 1.1.
SIDES	Him: 100 g diced chicken. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time; the author says to reheat by frying or in the microwave. My guidance: 3 days in the fridge; freeze the spare dumplings on a tray.
REHEAT	Fry gently in a little butter (author's preference), or microwave 60 to 90 s.
ALLERGENS	Wheat, eggs, milk (butter)
NOTE	You also need about 325 g of flour from the pantry. The recipe makes 8 servings: this plan eats 5 over two nights and freezes 3.

Lentil soup SATURDAY MIDDAY

For Saturday and Sunday lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 55 min · full recipe: recipetineats.com/lentil-soup (RecipeTin Eats)

BUY FOR IT	30 mL extra virgin olive oil; 150 g yellow onions; 0.2 bulb garlic; 150 g carrots; 150 g celery; 400 g green lentils, bulk bin; 400 mL diced tomatoes in juice; 1.5 L vegetable broth, low sodium; 1 lemon. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Soften onion and garlic, then carrot and celery, slowly. 2. Add lentils, tomato, broth and spices; simmer about 35 min. 3. Blitz a little of it to thicken, finish with lemon.
SPLIT	Set 2 servings aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 1 slice sourdough. Her: 1 slice sourdough, cheddar 30 g.
KEEP	5 days in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author).
REHEAT	Microwave 2 to 3 min with a splash of water.
ALLERGENS	None of the major allergens (check the broth label)
NOTE	Meatless (made with vegetable broth) and the cheapest pot in the plan.

Zapiekanka SATURDAY EVENING

For Saturday and Sunday dinners · Make the recipe once (2 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-zapiekanka (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	1 classic baguette; 300 g white mushrooms, loose; 80 g yellow onions; 150 g medium cheddar block. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Halve the baguette lengthwise and scoop out a little crumb. 2. Saute chopped mushrooms and onion 7 to 10 min; season. 3. Fill the bread, cover with grated cheese and bake until golden. 4. Finish with ketchup.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.57 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.43.
SIDES	Him: Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: Greek yogurt 175 g.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time. My guidance: cook the mushroom filling once, keep it 2 days, and bake the second night's halves fresh.
REHEAT	Bake 8 to 10 min at 400 F rather than microwaving.
ALLERGENS	Wheat, milk
NOTE	Polish street food. Costed with medium cheddar; the recipe suggests a mild cheese such as gouda.